

1 Tidal measurements

The tidal gauge at the western jetty was installed in the spring and calibrated against the old stone markings on the harbour wall. Its first months of data confirmed what the fishermen had always claimed: the flood tide arrives a few minutes earlier at the jetty than at the ferry slip, and the difference grows with the strength of the westerly wind. A simple float and pulley records the level on a paper drum, which is changed every Monday.

For the second season the float was replaced by a pressure sensor, and the paper drum by a small logger that stores one reading per minute. The new readings agree with the old ones to within a few millimetres, but they reveal short oscillations that the float had smoothed away. These seiches, as they are called, appear to be driven by the shape of the bay itself rather than by the tide.